John Viernes 10/11/2026

Competency Can (Not) be Replicated

Tools Used:

Claude
Purpose: To compile notes and give advice for what to do next

Example Prompt1 : “Hello, Claude. It's about time you put all that water to good use. I've got me 2 documents that I need you to study for another document I've got. Here's a quick Summary:
Here is my career direction and the evidence I used to develop it: I am working towards a job in Game Development and/or Game Design, the following documents 1B (AKA Strategic Framework) and 1C. 1B contains 3 of the best job applications I could find and charts of their individual requirements from entry to senior. 1C contains more of the same, but also singles out company-specific requirements, alongside visuals that tell what I must encourage and avoid. Separate what my sources directly support from my interpretations and assumptions. Identify up to three conclusions that need closer examination, including an overlooked option or contradiction if you find one. Explain which information led you to each observation and what additional evidence would test it. Ask for missing information. Do not invent job-market facts or rewrite my plan.
I am not asking you to go overboard like your grampa GPT and try to make a better version out of what I did. I simply wish that you work with me here.”

2: “Based on my current strategy and evidence, propose two meaningfully different career trajectories for the next three to five years. Treat them as conditional possibilities. For each, identify the assumptions, the evidence I already have, the evidence I would need, and a small step I could take now that would be useful across more than one possible future. Do not present invented roles, salaries, or forecasts as established facts.”

3: “I choose Trajectory B, Spellbrush's route, namely due to two things:

1. Spellbrush is one of two job listings still making actual games.
2. I did not know what game Akima was playing. I was just scrolling through listings for “Game Development Entry Level” And found this between Tabletop RPGs and Hasbro. I read the job description and no where in the listing did I find evidence of Akima making nothing but Flight Simulators and driving sims. Against all thoughts that tell me to just ignore this and move on, I accept this harrowing truth and leave myself with only 2 options left: Spellbrush and Epic.

Now all that's left is to wonder, what kinds of games does Spellbrush have in mind exactly? Are they into things like The Bazaar or somewhere along the lines of Darktide?”

4: “DAMMIT! So, Spellbrush AND Akima are off the table, only Epic is left, at a senior position, no less! Tell me, are there any 2 replacement listings for both Entry and Intermediate positions that better align with my interests? Namely horde-clearing RPGs like Darktide? I mean, you don't have to limit your findings to just Fatshark. It could be something fun or unassuming, like Aggro Crab or Landfall, but then again, I'm giving you free reign here, you don't have to limit yourself to the options I have given you.”

5: “What about listings at Bigmode?”

6: “Wait, the company behind Far Far West, what's its name? Does it fall into the same "Door left ajar" Pipe you've made for us?”

Only the results that were needed were kept, the rest was all my idea.

Eval and Reflection:

My experience using Claude was less about having AI choose my future for me and more about having a second set of eyes while I figured things out. With documents 1B and 1C already established, I needed something to organize my jumbled findings, suss out any possible blind spots, and shine a light on where to look next. Claude helped turn a pile of job listings and requirements with too many addendums to count into simpler, more manageable career options. More importantly, I specifically asked it to separate evidence from assumptions instead of rewriting my previous work or pretending to know me better than I myself could. Another benefit was having a tool that could keep up with my direction, one changing as much as the waves in a storm. When Spellbrush and Akima stopped looking like viable choices, I had to reopen the search instead of settling for whatever was available. Claude helped me explore replacement studios, consider alternative routes, and investigate companies such as Bigmode. This made the process less tedious and gave me new leads to examine. However, these ideas were starting points, not final decisions. The choice of what to save and throw away remained my own.

The biggest limitation was that AI could suggest an option without having enough evidence to establish that it actually fit my interests. Finding a job listing is one thing. Determining whether the studio makes the kinds of games I want to work on, whether the position matches my experience, and whether the opportunity is still available, are something else entirely. My questions about Spellbrush and Akima exposed this problem. I couldn’t just assume that a studio would be a good fit because its name appeared in a hyper specific recommendation. I needed stronger evidence about its work and the actual responsibilities of the position. Job listings can also disappear or change, making recommendations less useful if their information appears outdated. Though I cannot label every discarded suggestion a hallucination, the experience showed me why confident-sounding output should never automatically count as fact. My approach was to use Claude's suggestions as leads and return to the actual job descriptions when deciding whether they deserved consideration. When the available evidence did not establish a studio's suitability as something I was expecting, I treated it as a dead end rather than fill the gap with scatterbrained assumptions. In future searches, checking **official** career pages and the studios' published game portfolios will remain essential.

Throughout the process, I kept my own priorities at the center. I chose the initial career direction, developed the original framework, supplied the prompts, and made the final decisions about which opportunities deserved attention. Claude could suggest alternatives, but it could not determine what I considered an enjoyable game or which compromises I was willing to make. Ultimately, this collaboration reinforced my doubts about said collab, and taught me that AI is at its best behavior when I actively challenge and question its output instead of passively accepting it. It helped me organize the search and see additional possibilities, but my personal interests, judgment, and willingness to reconsider my strategy drove the process. My goal was never to have AI plan my **entire** future, it was to use AI to examine my options more efficiently while remaining responsible for the direction I choose.

Ethical Adherence:

I adhere to the rules of AI Usage as written by the City University of New York (CUNY) under the agreement that I do not use AI-Generated material to be passed off as my own. Any and all times that I *do* use AI are strictly organization and/or advice-based, the only robots I DON'T keep on a short leash, are the ones on TV and fictional media.